

Two Colleagues English — Production Handoff

Prepared for: Fable + Cowork | RAMP Linguistic Society | July 2026

FLAGGED RISK — READ FIRST

The production approach below (realistic cinematic video) was requested after a prior attempt at full AI-generated character video produced detached body parts and missing furniture/environment. That failure mode is a known current limitation of multi-character AI video generation (Kling, Veo, Sora, and vidIQ's own video models) — not a one-off glitch. Realistic + cinematic + two characters interacting with physical objects (menus, plates, trays, a counter) is the highest-risk combination for that exact failure to recur.

Recommendation before full production: generate one 15-30 second test clip of the two characters interacting with a single object (e.g., handing over a menu) before committing a full episode to this approach. If it fails, fall back to the still-image + voiceover + captions format (character cards, gentle pan/zoom, real B-roll for environment) — which vidIQ itself flagged as the more reliable standard for faceless channels.

1. CHARACTER STATUS

Marcia & Dave — SHELVED (office track, later)

- Marcia: adult woman, dark skin, medium-length brunette curly hair, hazel eyes, professional blazer and blouse
- Dave: adult man, light skin, short blond hair, green eyes, dress shirt and slacks
- Locked reference portraits exist in Canva (individual + combined scene)
- Existing assets: 30-scene main script + 5-scene Shorts promo (RAMP_EnglishOffice_VideoScript.docx), two-colleagues-english-skill.skill
- **Do not use for restaurant content.** Office track resumes on a separate timeline.

Restaurant Duo — TO BE DESIGNED (current priority)

Not yet named or designed. Naming should follow the language-mapped system below and match the still-vs-cinematic decision once tested.

2. CHANNEL: TWO COLLEAGUES ENGLISH

Format: Dialogue-based workplace English between two colleagues **Target audience:** Immigrant workers, intermediate English (B1-B2), can read English but lack speaking confidence in professional settings **Channel promise:** "I help working professionals speak English confidently at work by showing realistic office/workplace conversations between two colleagues — not textbook drills."

Niche decision (vidIQ, July 2026): Workplace English beat General English (saturated) and Spanish Fluency (fragmented, needs rebrand). Channel name "Two Colleagues" already telegraphs the value prop — no rebrand needed.

3. THE BIG THREE (vidIQ, July 2026) — restaurant is the starting niche

Rank	Niche	Breakout Score	Why
1	Restaurant / Hospitality	171x	Universal immigrant entry point; existing content is customer-side only ("how to order food"); worker-side content (taking orders, angry customers, kitchen English, shift handovers) is a content gap. One script ports across ~10 languages.
2	Healthcare / Caregiving	107x	Highest emotional stakes, largest immigrant workforce of any sector. Zero language content exists for immigrant healthcare workers specifically (only patient-side content exists).
3	Retail / Customer Service	Blue Ocean	Zero dedicated channels exist. Second-largest immigrant employer. Category creation opportunity — harder to measure demand since nobody's made this content yet.

Key insight from vidIQ: every breakout found was customer-side English content. Nobody is making worker-side content for these professions — that's the open gap, and

it holds across English, Spanish, French, or any target language.

Growth path:

- **Launch:** 5 restaurant videos released to open the channel, ahead of the regular posting cadence
- **Ongoing (post-launch):** 3 videos/week — build core audience
- Month 2: Continue restaurant + introduce healthcare, alternating weeks
- Month 3+: Add retail as third pillar; launch Spanish-language variant

Launch lineup (5 videos):

1. "How to Take an Order in English — Even When the Customer Speaks Fast"
2. "When the Customer Is Angry — De-escalation Phrases That Work"
3. "Kitchen English: What the Chef Is Actually Saying to You"
4. "Calling In Sick — What to Say to Your Manager (Without Feeling Guilty)"
5. "Shift Handover: Telling the Next Server What They Need to Know"

4. CHARACTER NAMING SYSTEM (per vidIQ, language-mapped)

Names adapt to the target audience so viewers see themselves reflected — a specific, culturally real name outperforms a generic one.

Language/Audience	Restaurant Server	Manager
English (US/UK)	Maria, Carlos, Fatima	James, Sarah
Spanish (immigrant workers learning Spanish)	Yesenia, Diego	Señor López
French	Amina, Karim	Monsieur Dubois

Cross-language strategy: one script skeleton ports directly across languages — e.g., "Two Colleagues English: The Angry Customer" becomes "Dos Colegas Español: El Cliente Enojado" with names swapped, scenario logic unchanged.

5. PRODUCTION APPROACH — LOCKED PER RUTHY'S DIRECTION (July 2026)

Format: realistic, cinematic AI-generated video (not still-image cards) **Voiceover:** two distinct voices, one per character, so dialogue sounds like two people actually talking **Animated whiteboard element:** used **only in the end-segment recap** (see below) — not present during the main dialogue portion of the episode **Captions:** no captions/subtitles baked into the video. Subtitles are optional for the viewer (on/off via YouTube's native caption toggle), never hardcoded into the visuals **End-segment recap (required in every episode):** a listening-comprehension / vocabulary recap using the animated whiteboard, with one or two characters taking turns — one asks a question, pauses, then gives the answer, reinforcing the episode's key vocabulary/phrases. This is the only portion of the video where the animated whiteboard appears.

Tooling caveat: vidIQ is the current default tool for this pipeline, not a locked-in requirement. If Fable identifies a better-suited tool for any part of this (script, voiceover, character video, or the whiteboard recap segment specifically), that substitution is open — the approach and constraints above are what's locked, not the vendor.

See risk flag at top of document — this approach has a higher failure risk than the still-image format based on the prior test result, and should be piloted on a short clip first.

6. WHAT VIDIQ CAN / CANNOT DO (current default tool — see tooling caveat in Section 5)

****Per vidIQ's own capability statement, July 2026:**Can do:**

- Full scripts (dialogue between two characters, with scene directions, timestamps, hooks, CTAs)
- Dual AI voiceovers, one per character
- Character reference images (consistent illustrated characters)
- Full video composition (voiceovers + captions + character images + scene transitions + B-roll)
- Branded animated captions

Cannot do:

- Full AI talking-head avatars with real-time lip sync (HeyGen/Synthesia-style). Still images can be generated and animated across scenes, but not real-time lip-synced talking video.
 - This is a factor in why the still-image format is the more reliable fallback if the cinematic approach doesn't hold up in testing.
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7. NEXT STEPS

1. Test clip: generate one 15-30 second cinematic clip of the restaurant duo interacting with a single object, before full production commitment
 2. Design and name the restaurant duo (server + manager) per the naming table above
 3. Lock reference images for the new duo
 4. Write full scripts for all 5 launch videos, including the animated-whiteboard recap segment in each
 5. Produce dual voiceovers for the launch batch
 6. Compose all 5 episodes; evaluate against the risk flag before releasing the launch batch and moving to the ongoing 3-videos/week cadence
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This document consolidates decisions made across prior Claude sessions and the current vidIQ niche research (Big Three report, character naming logic, capability confirmation) for handoff into Fable and Cowork.